Sl. No.	Period	Coalition	Prime Minister (Party)	Partners
6.	1997–1998	United Front	I.K. Gujral (Janata Dal)	Janata Dal, CPI, TMC, SP, DMK, AGP, TDP and others. Congress supported from outside.
7.	1998–1999	BJP-led Coalition	A.B. Vajpayee (BJP)	BJP, AIADMK, BJD, Shiv Sena, Lok Shakti, Arunachal Congress, Samata, Akali Dal, PMK, TRC and others. TDP and Trinamool Congress supported from outside.
8.	1999–2004	National Democratic Alliance (NDA)	A.B. Vajpayee (BJP)	BJP, JD (U), Trinamool Congress, Shiv Sena, BJD, LJP, DMK, PMK, INLD, MDMK, National Conference, Akali Dal, RLD, AGP and others.
9.	2004–2009	United Progressive Alliance (UPA)	Manmohan Singh (Congress)	Congress, NCP, DMK, RJD, LJP, PMK and others. CPI and CPM supported from outside.
10.	2009–2014	United Progressive Alliance-II (UPA-II)	Manmohan Singh (Congress)	Congress, NCP, DMK, Trinamool Congress, National Conference and others.
11.	2014–2019	National Democratic Alliance (NDA)	Narendra Modi (BJP)	BJP, LJP, TDP, Shiv Sena, Akali Dal, Rashtriya Lok Samata Party, Apna Dal (S) and others. TDP left NDA in 2018.
12.	2019–till date	National Democratic Alliance (NDA)	Narendra Modi (BJP)	BJP, Akali Dal, LJP, Shiv Sena and others. Shiv Sena left NDA in 2019 and Akali Dal in 2020.

MERITS

The various advantages or strengths of the coalition governments are as follows:

1. There is an accommodation of diverse interests in the functioning of the government. A coalition government acts as a channel to meet the expectations and redress the grievances of different groups.

2. India is a highly diversified country. There are different cultures, languages, castes, religions and ethnic groups, and all these get represented in the coalition governments. This means that a